SPORTS & GAMES

Finger plays for nursery and kindergarten

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[Transcriber's Note: The original book contains illustrations of the hand gestures for the finger plays. In this plaintext e-book, the gestures are described in brackets unless they are explained in, or are obvious from, the original.]

FINGER PLAYS

FOR NURSERY AND KINDERGARTEN

BY

EMILIE POULSSON

[Illustration]

Music By

CORNELIA C. ROESKE

Illustrations By L.J. BRIDGMAN

[D. Lothrop Company Boston 1893]

[Illustration: "WHAT THE CHILD IMITATES, HE BEGINS TO UNDERSTAND."--_Froebel._]

PREFACE.

"What the child imitates," says Froebel, "he begins to understand. Let him represent the flying of birds and he enters partially into the life of birds. Let him imitate the rapid motion of fishes in the water and his sympathy with fishes is quickened. Let him reproduce the activities of farmer, miller and baker, and his eyes open to the meaning of their work. In one word let him reflect in his play the varied aspects of life and his thought will begin to grapple with their significance."

In all times and among all nations, finger-plays have been a delight of childhood. Countless babies have laughed and crowed over "Pat-a-cake" and other performances of the soft little hands; while children of whatever age never fail to find amusement in playing

"Here is the church, And here's the steeple, Open the doors, And here are the people!"

and others as well known.

Yet it is not solely upon the pleasure derived from them, that finger-plays depend for their _raison d'etre_. By their judicious and early use, the development of strength

and flexibility in the tiny lax fingers may be assisted, and dormant thought may receive its first awakening call through the motions which interpret as well as illustrate the phase of life or activity presented by the words.

The eighteen finger-plays contained in this book have already, through publication in BABYLAND, been introduced to their especial public, and have been much used in homes, though perhaps more in kindergartens. It will readily be seen that while some of the plays are for the babies in the nursery, others are more suitable for older children.

A baby-friend, ten months old, plays "All for Baby" throughout, pounding and clapping gleefully with all his might--while children seven or eight years of age play and sing "The Caterpillar," "How the Corn Grew" and others with very evident enjoyment.

With a little study of the charming and expressive pictures with which the artist, Mr. L.J. Bridgman, has so sympathetically illustrated the rhymes, mothers and kindergartners have easily understood what motions were intended. To elucidate still farther, however, the playing of "The Merry Little Men" may be thus described:

During the singing of the first verse, the children look about in every direction for the "little men," but keep the hands hidden. At the beginning of the second verse, raise both hands to full view with fingers outspread and quiet. At the words, "The first to come," etc., let the thumbs be shown alone, then the others as named in turn, till all are again outspread as at the beginning of the second verse. In the last verse the arms are moved from side to side, hands being raised and fingers fluttering nimbly all the time. When displaying the "busy little men," raise the hands as high as possible.

The music, composed by Miss Cornelia C. Roeske, will be found melodious and attractive and especially suited to the voices and abilities of the very young children for whom it is chiefly intended.

The harmonic arrangement is also purposely simple in consideration of the many mothers and kindergartners who cannot devote time to preparatory practice.

EMILIE POULSSON.

Boston, 1889.

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DEDICATED

TO

LITTLE CHILDREN

AT HOME AND IN KINDERGARTEN

BY THEIR FRIEND,

EMILIE POULSSON.

[Illustration: NURSERY FINGER PLAYS]

[Illustration: I. THE LITTLE MEN.]

I.--THE LITTLE MEN.

Oh! where are the merry, merry Little Men To join us in our play? And where are the busy, busy Little Men To help us work to-day?

[Illustration: MERRY LITTLE MEN]

[Illustration: BUSY LITTLE MEN]

Upon each hand A little band For work or play is ready. The first to come Is Master Thumb; Then Pointer, strong and steady;

[Illustration: MASTER THUMB. [thumb extended]]

[Illustration: POINTER. [index finger extended]]

Then Tall Man high; And just close by The Feeble Man doth linger; And last of all, So fair and small, The baby--Little Finger.

[Illustration: TALL MAN. [middle finger extended]]

[Illustration: THE FEEBLE MAN. [ring finger extended]]

[Illustration: THE BABY. [little finger extended]]

Yes! here are the merry, merry Little Men To join us in our play; And here are the busy, busy Little Men To help us work to-day.

[Illustration]

[Music: THE MERRY LITTLE MEN.

EMILIE POULSSON.

CORNELIA C. ROESKE.

Oh! where are the merry, merry Little Men To join us in our play? And where are the busy, busy Little Men To help us work to-day?

Upon each hand A little band For work or play is ready. The first to come Is Master Thumb; Then Pointer, strong and steady;

Then Tall Man high; And just close by The Feeble Man doth linger; And last of all, So fair and small, The baby--Little Finger.

Yes! here are the merry, merry Little Men To join us in our play; And here are the busy, busy Little Men To help us work to-day.]

II.--THE LAMBS.

This is the meadow where all the long day Ten little frolicsome lambs are at play.

[Illustration: THE MEADOW [hands clasped so arms form a circle]]

These are the measures the good farmer brings Salt in, or cornmeal, and other good things.

[Illustration: THE MEASURES [hands cupped]]

This is the lambkins' own big water-trough; Drink, little lambkins, and then scamper off!

[Illustration: THE TROUGH [hands held together and cupped]]

This is the rack where in winter they feed; Hay makes a very good dinner indeed.

[Illustration: THE RACK [hands back to back with fingers interlaced and raised]]

These are the big shears to shear the old sheep; Dear little lambkins their soft wool may keep.

[Illustration: THE SHEARS [index and middle fingers extended sideways]]

Here, with its big double doors shut so tight, This is the barn where they all sleep at night.

[Illustration: THE BARN [hands clasped and held upward]]

[Music: THE LAMBS.

EMILIE POULSSON.

CORNELIA C. ROESKE.

1. This is the meadow where all the long day Ten little frolicsome lambs are at play. These are the measures the good farmer brings Salt in, or corn meal, and other good things.]

2. This is the lambkins' own big water-trough; Drink, little lambkins, and then scamper off! This is the rack where in winter they feed; Hay makes a very good dinner indeed.

3. These are the big shears to shear the old sheep; Dear little lambkins their soft wool may keep. Here, with its big double doors shut so tight, This is the barn where they all sleep at night.

[Illustration: III. THE HEN AND CHICKENS.]

III.--THE HEN AND CHICKENS.

Good Mother Hen sits here on her nest, Keeps the eggs warm beneath her soft breast, Waiting, waiting, day after day.

[Illustration: ON THE NEST. [right hand horizontal with fingers slightly curved; left hand in fist on top of right hand, with index finger raised and curved]]

Hark! there's a sound she knows very well: Some little chickens are breaking the shell, Pecking, pecking, pecking away.

[Illustration: BREAKING THE SHELL [fingers curved, thumb touching middle finger]]

Now they're all out, Oh, see what a crowd! Good Mother Hen is happy and proud, Cluck-cluck, cluck-cluck, clucking away.

[Illustration: HAPPY AND PROUD [fist with index finger raised and curved]]

Into the coop the mother must go; But all the chickens run to and fro, Peep-peep, peep-peep, peeping away.

[Illustration: THE COOP. [palm downward, fingers curved and separated]]

[Illustration: "RUN TO AND FRO" [index and middle fingers "running"]]

Here is some corn in my little dish; Eat, Mother Hen, eat all that you wish, Picking, picking, picking away.

[Illustration: EATING [left hand cupped, right fist with index finger extended and curved]]

Happy we'll be to see you again, Dear little chicks and good Mother Hen! Now good-by, good-by for to-day.

[Music: THE HEN AND CHICKENS.

EMILIE POULSSON.

CORNELIA C. ROESKE.

1. Good Mother Hen sits here on her nest, Keeps the eggs warm beneath her soft breast, Waiting, waiting, day after day.

2. Hark! there's a sound she knows very well: Some little chickens breaking the shell, Pecking, pecking, pecking away.

3. Now they're all out, oh, see what a crowd! Good Mother Hen is happy and proud, Cluck-cluck, cluck-cluck, clucking away.]

4. Into the coop the mother must go; While all the chickens run to and fro, Peep-peep, peep-peep, peeping away.

5. Here is some corn in my little dish; Eat, Mother Hen, eat all that you wish. Picking, picking, picking away.

6. Happy we'll be to see you again, Dear little chicks and good Mother Hen! Now good-bye, good-bye for to-day.

[Illustration: IV. THE LITTLE PLANT.]

IV.--THE LITTLE PLANT.

In my little garden bed Raked so nicely over, First the tiny seeds I sow, Then with soft earth cover.

[Illustration: THE BED. [palms facing each other, curved fingers touching]]

[Illustration: THE RAKE. [fingers extended downward]]

[Illustration: SEEDS I SOW. [fingers closed and curved, palm down]]

[Illustration: WITH SOFT EARTH COVER. [palms down and curved]]

Shining down, the great round sun Smiles upon it often; Little raindrops, pattering down, Help the seeds to soften.

[Illustration: THE GREAT ROUND SUN. [arms extended over head and curved]]

[Illustration: PATTERING.

DRUMMING WITH THE FINGER-TIPS.]

Then the little plant awakes! Down the roots go creeping. Up it lifts its little head Through the brown mould peeping.

[Illustration: "DOWN THE ROOTS GO" [fingers downward with middle 3 fingers together]]

[Illustration: "LIFTS ITS LITTLE HEAD" [thumb extended upward]]

High and higher still it grows Through the summer hours, Till some happy day the buds Open into flowers.

[Illustration: "OPEN INTO FLOWERS" [palm up, fingers curved]]

[Illustration: "STILL IT GROWS"

ELEVATING THE ARM AND RAISING THE THUMB FROM THE HAND]

[Music: THE LITTLE PLANT.

EMILIE POULSSON.

C.C. ROESKE.

1. In my little garden bed Rak'd so nicely over, First the tiny seeds I sow, Then with soft earth cover. Shining down, the great round sun Smiles upon it often; Little raindrops, patt'ring down, Help the seeds to soften.

2. Then the little plant awakes! Down the roots go creeping. Up it lifts its little head Thro' the brown mould peeping. High and higher still it grows Thro' the summer hours, Till some happy day the buds Open into flowers.]

[Illustration: V. THE PIGS.]

V.--THE PIGS.

Piggie Wig and Piggie Wee, Hungry pigs as pigs could be, For their dinner had to wait Down behind the barnyard gate.

[Illustration: PIGGY WIG [fingers of both hands extended sideways with tips touching, left thumb raised]]

[Illustration: PIGGY WEE [fingers of both hands extended sideways with tips touching, right thumb raised]]

[Illustration: BEHIND THE GATE [fingers of both hands extended sideways with tips touching]]

Piggie Wig and Piggie Wee Climbed the barnyard gate to see, Peeping through the gate so high, But no dinner could they spy.

[Illustration: PEEPING THROUGH [fingers of both hands extended sideways with tips touching; index fingers slightly lifted and thumb tips sticking through gap]]

Piggie Wig and Piggie Wee Got down sad as pigs could be; But the gate soon opened wide And they scampered forth outside.

[Illustration: OPENED WIDE [hands held sideways away from each other]]

[Illustration: SCAMPERED FORTH [fists downward, thumbs extended downward]]

Piggie Wig and Piggie Wee, What was their delight to see Dinner ready not far off-- Such a full and tempting trough!

[Illustration: THE TROUGH [hands cupped together]]

Piggie Wig and Piggie Wee, Greedy pigs as pigs could be, For their dinner ran pell-mell; In the trough both piggies fell.

[Illustration: IN THEY FELL [hands cupped together, thumbs downward]]

[Music: THE PIGS.

EMILIE POULSSON.

CORNELIA C. ROESKE.

1. Piggie Wig and Piggie Wee, Hungry pigs as pigs could be, For their dinner had to wait Down behind the barnyard gate.]

2. Piggie Wig and Piggie Wee Climbed the barnyard gate to see, Peeping through the gate so high, But no dinner could they spy.

3. Piggie Wig and Piggie Wee Got down sad as pigs could be; But the gate soon opened wide And they scampered forth outside.

4. Piggie Wig and Piggie Wee, What was their delight to see Dinner ready not far off-- Such a full and tempting trough!

5. Piggie Wig and Piggie Wee, Greedy pigs as pigs could be, For their dinner ran pell-mell; In the trough both piggies fell.

[Illustration: VI. A LITTLE BOY'S WALK.]

VI.--A LITTLE BOY'S WALK.

A little boy went walking One lovely summer's day: He saw a little rabbit That quickly ran away;

[Illustration: THE RABBIT [index and middle finger in "V" sign]]

[Illustration: RAN AWAY [same, with arm moving behind back]]

He saw a shining river Go winding in and out, And little fishes in it Were swimming all about;

[Illustration: SHINING RIVER [hands describing a long curve]]

[Illustration: THE FISHES [fingers waggling downward]]

And, slowly, slowly turning, The great wheel of the mill; And then the tall church steeple, The little church so still;

[Illustration: MILL WHEEL [hands turning over each other]]

[Illustration: CHURCH STEEPLE [hands clasped upward, index fingers steepled]]

The bridge above the water; And when he stopped to rest, He saw among the bushes A wee ground-sparrow's nest.

[Illustration: THE BRIDGE [palms downward, fingers straight and interlaced, thumbs extended downward]]

[Illustration: THE NEST [hands cupped sideways to form circle]]

And as he watched the birdies Above the tree-tops fly, He saw the clouds a-sailing Across the sunny sky.

[Illustration: ABOVE THE TREE-TOP FLY [arms and hands extended upward]]

[Illustration: CLOUDS A-SAILING [one arm extended upward, fingers curved]]

He saw the insects playing; The flowers that summer brings; He said, "I'll go tell mamma! I've seen _so many_ things!"

[Illustration: INSECTS PLAYING [fingers waggling downward]]

[Illustration: FLOWERS [fingers of both hands extended straight downward]]

[Music: A LITTLE BOY'S WALK.

EMILIE POULSSON.

CORNELIA C. ROESKE.

A little boy went walking One lovely summer's day: He saw a little rabbit That quickly ran away; He saw a shining river Go winding in and out, And little fishes in it Were swimming all about.

And slowly, slowly turning, The great wheel of the mill; And then the tall church steeple, The little church so still; The bridge above the water; And when he stopped to rest, He saw among the bushes A wee ground-sparrow's nest,

And as he watched the birdies Above the tree-tops fly, He saw the clouds a-sailing Across the sunny sky. He saw the insects playing; The flowers that summer brings; He said, "I'll go tell Mamma! I've seen _so many_ things."]

[Illustration: VII. THE CATERPILLAR.]

VII.--THE CATERPILLAR.

Fuzzy little caterpillar, Crawling, crawling on the ground! Fuzzy little caterpillar, Nowhere, nowhere to be found, Though we've looked and looked and hunted Everywhere around!

[Illustration: CRAWLING

(Move whole hand forward and wriggle the thumb)]

[Illustration: NOWHERE TO BE FOUND [fists downward]]

When the little caterpillar Found his furry coat too tight, Then a snug cocoon he made him Spun of silk so soft and light; Rolled himself away within it-- Slept there day and night.

[Illustration: ROLLED HIMSELF AWAY

(Rotate the thumb, then double into the hand)]

See how this cocoon is stirring! Now a little head we spy-- What! Is _this_ our caterpillar Spreading gorgeous wings to dry? Soon the free and happy creature Flutters gayly by.

[Illustration: STIRRING [fist downward, moving back and forth]]

[Illustration: A HEAD WE SPY [fist downward, thumb extended sideways]]

[Illustration: SPREADING GORGEOUS WINGS [hands back to back, thumbs extended together]]

[Illustration: FLUTTERS BY

(Move palms to and fro)]

[Music: THE CATERPILLAR.

EMILIE POULSSON.

CORNELIA C. ROESKE.

1. Fuzzy little caterpillar, Crawling, crawling on the ground! Fuzzy little caterpillar, Nowhere, nowhere to be found, Tho' we've looked and looked and hunted Everywhere around!

2. When the little caterpillar Found his furry coat too tight, Then a snug cocoon he made him Spun of silk so soft and light; Rolled himself away within it-- Slept there day and night.

3. See how this cocoon is stirring! Now a little head we spy-- What! is _this_ our caterpillar Spreading gorgeous wings to dry? Soon the free and happy creature Flutters gaily by.]

[Illustration: VIII. ALL FOR BABY.]

VIII.--ALL FOR BABY.

Here's a ball for Baby, Big and soft and round! Here is Baby's hammer-- O, how he can pound!

[Illustration: A BALL [fingers of both hands curved and touching]]

[Illustration: THE HAMMER [one fist beating on another]]

Here is Baby's music-- Clapping, clapping so! Here are Baby's soldiers, Standing in a row!

[Illustration: CLAPPING]

[Illustration: SOLDIERS [fingers of both hands spread upward]]

Here's the Baby's trumpet, Toot-too-toot! too-too! Here's the way that Baby Plays at "Peep-a-boo!"

[Illustration: TRUMPET [right fist at mouth, left fist touching right]]

[Illustration: PLAYS AT "PEEP-A-BOO!" [fingers covering eyes]]

Here's a big umbrella-- Keep the Baby dry! Here's the Baby's cradle-- Rock-a-baby-by!

[Illustration: UMBRELLA [left fist with index finger upward; right hand extended flat over left index finger]]

[Illustration: CRADLE [fingers interlaced with index fingers steepled]]

[Music: ALL FOR BABY.

EMILIE POULSSON.

CORNELIA C. ROESKE.

1. Here's a ball for Baby, Big and soft and round! Here is Baby's hammer-- O, how he can pound!]

2. Here is Baby's music Clapping, clapping so! Here are Baby's soldiers, Standing in a row!

3. Here's the Baby's trumpet, Toot-too-toot! too-too! Here's the way that Baby Plays at "Peep-a-boo!"

4. Here's a big umbrella-- Keeps the Baby dry! Here's the Baby's cradle-- Rock-a-baby by!

[Illustration: IX. THE MICE.]

IX.--THE MICE.

Five little mice on the pantry floor, Seeking for bread-crumbs or something more;

[Illustration: FIVE LITTLE MICE [hand extended upward]]

Five little mice on the shelf up high, Feasting so daintily on a pie--

[Illustration: MICE ON THE SHELF [fingers of one hand curved downward and resting on the backs of the fingers of the other hand]]

[Illustration: A PIE [fingers of both hands touching to form circle]]

But the big round eyes of the wise old cat See what the five little mice are at.

[Illustration: BIG ROUND EYES [thumb and fingertips of each hand forming circles]]

Quickly she jumps!--but the mice run away, And hide in their snug little holes all day.

[Illustration: "MICE RUN AWAY"

Left hand lowered suddenly [Pounce of the cat] Right hand brought behind the back [Mice run away]]

"Feasting in pantries may be very nice; But home is the best!" say the five little mice.

[Illustration: HOME [fingers interlaced sideways]]

[Music: FIVE LITTLE MICE.

EMILIE POULSSON.

CORNELIA C. ROESKE.

1. Five little mice on the pantry floor, Seeking for bread crumbs or something more; Five little mice on the shelf up high, Feasting so daintily on a pie-- But the big round eyes of the wise old cat See what the five little mice are at. Quickly she jumps! but the mice run away. And hide in their snug little holes all day. "Feasting in pantries may be very nice; But home is the best!" say the five little mice.]

[Illustration: X. THE SQUIRREL.]

X.--THE SQUIRREL

"Little squirrel, living there In the hollow tree, I've a pretty cage for you; Come and live with me!

[Illustration: IN THE HOLLOW TREE [thumb and fingertips of left hand forming circle; thumb of right hand sticking through circle]]

[Illustration: THE CAGE [palms facing each other, fingers slightly curved and separated, tips touching]]

"You may turn the little wheel-- That will be great fun! Slowly round, or very fast If you faster run.

[Illustration: THE WHEEL [index fingers turning over each other]]

"Little squirrel, I will bring In my basket here Every day a feast of nuts! Come, then, squirrel dear."

[Illustration: THE BASKET [palms upward, fingers interlace, thumb tips touching]]

[Illustration: THE NUTS [fingertips of each hand touching to form circles]]

But the little squirrel said From his hollow tree: "Oh! no, no! I'd rather far Live here and be free!"

So my cage is empty yet, And the wheel is still; But my little basket here Oft with nuts I fill.

If you like, I'll crack the nuts, Some for you and me, For the squirrel has enough In his hollow tree.

[Illustration: CRACKING NUTS [one fist hammering on the other]]

[Music: THE SQUIRREL.

EMILIE POULSSON.

CORNELIA C. ROESKE.

1. "Little Squirrel, living there In the hollow tree, I've a pretty cage for you; Come and live with me! You may turn the little wheel-- That will be great fun! Slowly round, or very fast If you faster run."

2. "Little Squirrel, I will bring In my basket here Every day a feast of nuts! Come then, squirrel dear." But the little squirrel said From his hollow tree: "Oh! no, no! I'd rather far Live here and be free."

3. So my cage is empty yet And the wheel is still; But my little basket here Oft with nuts I fill. If you like, I'll crack the nuts, Some for you and me, For the squirrel has enough In his hollow tree.]

[Illustration: XI. THE SPARROWS.]

XI.--THE SPARROWS.

"Little brown sparrows, Flying around, Up in the tree-tops, Down on the ground,

"Come to my window, Dear sparrows, come! See! I will give you Many a crumb.

[Illustration: FLYING AROUND

Fluttering the Fingers]

[Illustration: TREE TOPS [both hands extended upward]]

[Illustration: ON THE GROUND [palms downward, fingers resting on ground]]

[Illustration: THE WINDOW [palms downward, fingers of one resting on fingers of other to form square top]]

[Illustration: MANY A CRUMB [thumb rubbing fingertips]]

"Here is some water, Sparkling and clear; Come, little sparrows, Drink without fear.

"If you are tired, Here is a nest; Wouldn't you like to Come here to rest?"

All the brown sparrows Flutter away, Chirping and singing, "We cannot stay;

"For in the tree-tops, 'Mong the gray boughs, There is the sparrows' Snug little house."

[Illustration: SOME WATER [hand cupped, palm up]]

[Illustration: A NEST [fingers of both hands interlaced to form circle]]

[Illustration: THE HOUSE [palms together, fingers steepling]]

[Illustration: FLY AWAY

Raise Hands

Fluttering Fingers]

[Music: THE SPARROWS.

EMILIE POULSSON.

C.C. ROESKE.

1. "Little brown sparrows, Flying around, Up in the tree-tops, Down on the ground, Come to my window, Dear sparrows, come! See! I will give you Many a crumb."

2. "Here is some water, Sparkling and clear; Come, little sparrows, Drink without fear. If you are tired, Here is a nest; Wouldn't you like to Come here and rest?"

3. All the brown sparrows Flutter away, Chirping and singing, "We cannot stay; For in the tree-tops, 'Mong the gray boughs, There is the sparrows' Snug little house."]

[Illustration: XII. THE COUNTING LESSON.]

XII.--THE COUNTING LESSON.

(_Right hand._) Here is the beehive. Where are the bees? Hidden away where nobody sees. Soon they come creeping out of the hive-- One!--two!--three! four! five!

[Illustration: THE BEEHIVE [fist with knuckles downward]]

[Illustration: ONE [same, thumb extended]]

[Illustration: TWO [same, plus index finger extended]]

[Illustration: THREE [same, plus middle finger extended]]

[Illustration: FOUR [same, plus ring finger extended]]

[Illustration: FIVE [all fingers extended downward]]

[Illustration: WORKER]

[Illustration: DRONE]

[Illustration: QUEEN]

(_Left hand._) Once I saw an ant-hill With no ants about; So I said, "Dear little ants, Won't you please come out?" Then as if the little ants Had heard my call-- One! two! three! four! _five_ came out! And that was all!

[Illustration: ANT-HILL [fist with palm downward]]

[Illustration: ONE [fist with knuckles downward, thumb extended]]

[Illustration: TWO [same, plus index finger extended]]

[Illustration: THREE [same, plus middle finger extended]]

[Illustration: FOUR [same, plus ring finger extended]]

[Illustration: FIVE [all fingers extended downward]]

[Illustration: Male]

[Illustration: Female]

[Illustration: Worker]

[Music: THE COUNTING LESSON.

EMILIE POULSSON.

C.C. ROESKE.

1ST VERSE.

1. Here is the beehive. Where are the bees? Hidden away where nobody sees. Soon they come creeping out of the hive-- One!--two!--three! four! _five_!

2ND VERSE.

2. Once I saw an ant hill With no ants about; So I said, "Dear little ants, Won't you please come out?" Then as if the little ants Had heard my call-- One! two! three! four! _five_ came out! And that was all!]

[Illustration: XIII. MRS. PUSSY'S DINNER.]

XIII.--MRS. PUSSY'S DINNER.

Mrs. Pussy, sleek and fat, With her kittens four, Went to sleep upon the mat By the kitchen door.

[Illustration: MRS. PUSSY

(Right hand) [fist, thumb extended upward]]

[Illustration: KITTENS FOUR [four fingers extended upward]]

[Illustration: UPON THE MAT [fist, palm upward]]

Mrs. Pussy heard a noise-- Up she jumped in glee: "Kittens, maybe that's a mouse! Let us go and see!"

[Illustration: UP SHE JUMPED [open fist]]

Creeping, creeping, creeping on, Silently they stole; But the little mouse had gone Back within its hole.

[Illustration: CREEPING [palm downward, fingers walking]]

[Illustration: MOUSE

(Left hand) [fist with knuckles downward, thumb extended]]

[Illustration: WITHIN ITS HOLE [fist with palm downward]]

"Well," said Mrs. Pussy then, "To the barn we'll go; We shall find the swallow there Flying to and fro."

[Illustration: THE BARN [arms raised, fingertips touching]]

[Illustration: TO AND FRO [hands waving, fingers curved]]

So the cat and kittens four Tried their very best; But the swallows flying fast Safely reached the nest!

[Illustration: NEST [hands cupped sideways to form circle]]

Home went hungry Mrs. Puss And her kittens four; Found their dinner on a plate By the kitchen door.

[Illustration: PLATE [thumbs and index fingers touching to form circle]]

As they gathered round the plate, They agreed 'twas nice That it could not run away Like the birds and mice!

[Music: MRS. PUSSY'S DINNER.

EMILIE POULSSON.

C.C. ROESKE.

1. Mrs. Pussy, sleek and fat, With her kittens four, Went to sleep upon the mat By the kitchen door.]

2. Mrs. Pussy heard a noise-- Up she jumped in glee: "Kittens, maybe that's a mouse! Let us go and see!"

3. Creeping, creeping, creeping on, Silently they stole; But the little mouse had gone Back within its hole.

4. "Well," said Mrs. Pussy then, "To the barn we'll go; We shall find the swallows there Flying to and fro."

5. So the cat and kittens four Tried their very best; But the swallows flying fast Safely reached the nest!

6. Home went hungry Mrs. Puss And her kittens four; Found their dinner on a plate By the kitchen door.

7. As they gathered round the plate, They agreed 'twas nice That it could not run away Like the birds and mice!

[Illustration: XIV. HOW THE CORN GREW.]

XIV.--HOW THE CORN GREW.

There was a field that waiting lay, All hard and brown and bare; There was a thrifty farmer came And fenced it in with care.

[Illustration: THE FIELD. [two children facing each other with their arms extended onto each other's shoulders]]

Then came a plowman with his plow; From early until late, Across the field and back again, He plowed the furrows straight.

[Illustration: THE PLOW. [hands together sideways, thumbs extended slightly upward]]

The harrow then was brought to make The ground more soft and loose; And soon the farmer said with joy, "My field is fit for use."

[Illustration: THE HARROW. [palms downward, fingers curved and separated]]

For many days the farmer then Was working with his hoe; And little Johnny brought the corn And dropped the kernels--so!

[Illustration: THE HOE. [palm downward, fingers together and bent at knuckles]]

[Illustration: DROPPED THE KERNELS--SO! [palm downward, fingers curved]]

And there they lay, until awaked By tapping rains that fell, Then pushed their green plumes up to greet The sun they loved so well.

[Illustration: TAPPING RAINS.

(Drumming with the fingers)]

[Illustration: POKED THEIR GREEN PLUMES UP. [fingers together extending upward]]

Then flocks and flocks of hungry crows Came down the corn to taste; But ba-ang!--went the farmer's gun And off they flew in haste.

[Illustration: THE GUN.

(Snap the fingers) [one arm extended, holding elbow with other hand]]

Then grew and grew the corn, until, When autumn days had come, With sickles keen they cut it down, And sang the "Harvest Home."

[Illustration: THE SICKLE. [one arm extended and curved]]

[Music: HOW THE CORN GREW.

EMILIE POULSSON.

CORNELIA C. ROESKE.

1. There was a field that waiting lay, All hard and brown and bare; There was a thrifty farmer came And fenced it in with care, There was a thrifty farmer came And fenced it in with care.]

2. Then came a ploughman with his plough; From early until late, Across the field and back again, He ploughed the furrows straight.

3. The harrow then was brought to make The ground more soft and loose; And soon the farmer said with joy, "My field is fit for use."

4. For many days the farmer then Was working with his hoe; And little Johnny brought the corn And dropped the kernels--so!

5. And there they lay, until awaked By tapping rains that fell, Then pushed their green plumes up to greet The sun they loved so well.

6. Then flocks and flocks of hungry crows Came down the corn to taste; But ba-ang! went the farmer's gun, And off they flew in haste.

7. Then grew and grew the corn, until, When autumn days had come, With sickles keen they cut it down, And sang the "Harvest Home."

[Illustration: XV. THE MILL.]

XV.--THE MILL.

A merry little river Went singing day by day, Until it reached a mill-dam That stretched across its way.

[Illustration: THE MILLDAM. [hand sideways, fingers straight]]

And there it spread its waters, A quiet pond, to wait Until the busy miller Should lift the water-gate.

[Illustration: LIFT THE WATER-GATE. [hands sideways, bent at knuckles, fingers straight]]

Then, hurrying through the gateway, The dashing waters found A mighty millwheel waiting, And turned it swiftly round.

[Illustration: THE MILLWHEEL. [hands turning over one another]]

But faster turned the millstones Up in the dusty mill, And quickly did the miller With corn the hopper fill.

[Illustration: THE MILLSTONES. [palms downward, fingers straight, one hand moving in a circle on top of the other]]

And faster yet and faster The heavy stones went round, Until the golden kernels To golden meal were ground.

"Now fill the empty hopper With _wheat_," the miller said; "We'll grind this into flour To make the children's bread."

[Illustration: THE HOPPER. [hands cupped together]]

And still, as flowed the water, The mighty wheel went round; And still, as turned the millstones, The corn and grain were ground.

And busy was the miller The livelong day, until The water-gate he fastened, And silent grew the mill.

[Music: THE MILL.

EMILIE POULSSON.

CORNELIA C. ROESKE.

1. A merry little river Went singing day by day, Until it reached a mill-dam That stretched across its way. And there it spread its waters, A quiet pond, to wait Until

the busy miller Should lift the water gate.]

2. Then, hurrying through the gateway, The dashing waters found A mighty millwheel waiting-- And turned it swiftly round. But faster turned the millstone Up in the dusty mill, And quickly did the miller With corn the hopper fill.

3. And faster yet and faster The heavy stones went round, Until the golden kernels To golden meal were ground. "Now, fill the empty hopper With _wheat_," the miller said; "We'll grind this into flour To make the children's bread."

4. And still, as flowed the water, The mighty wheel went round; And still, as turned the millstones, The corn and grain were ground. And busy was the miller The livelong day, until The water gate he fastened, And silent grew the mill.

[Illustration: XVI. MAKING BREAD.]

XVI.--MAKING BREAD.

"The farmer and the miller Have worked," the mother said, "And got the flour ready, So I will make the bread." She scooped from out the barrel The flour white as snow, And in her sieve she put it And shook it to and fro.

[Illustration: THE SCOOP. [hands cupped together]]

[Illustration: THE SIEVE. [fingers interlaced, palms upward, thumbs meeting]]

Then in the pan of flour A little salt she threw; A cup of yeast she added, And poured in water, too. To mix them all together She stirred with busy might, Then covered it and left it Until the bread was light.

[Illustration: PAN. [arms curved, fingers meeting]]

[Illustration: "SALT SHE THREW." [thumb and fingertips together]]

[Illustration: A CUP OF YEAST. [palm upward, fingers curved]]

[Illustration: STIRRING. [fingers together, stirring]]

[Illustration: COVERING. [palms downward, fingers slightly curved]]

More flour then she sifted And kneaded well the dough, And in the waiting oven The loaves of bread did go. The mother watched the baking, And turned the loaves, each one, Until at last, rejoicing, She said, "My bread is done!"

[Illustration: KNEADING. [fists moving up and down]]

[Illustration: TURNED THE LOAVES. [fists turning sideways]]

[Music: MAKING BREAD.

EMILIE POULSSON.

C.C. ROESKE.

1. "The farmer and the miller Have work'd," the mother said, "And got the flour ready, So I will make the bread." She scooped from out the barrel The flour white as snow, And in her sieve she put it And shook it to and fro.]

2. Then in the pan of flour A little salt she threw; A cup of yeast she added, And poured in water, too. To mix them all together She stirred with busy might, Then covered it and left it Until the bread was light.

3. More flour then she sifted And kneaded well the dough, And in the waiting oven The loaves of bread did go. The mother watched the baking, And turned the loaves, each one, Until at last, rejoicing, She said, "My bread is done!"

[Illustration: XVII. MAKING BUTTER.]

XVII.--MAKING BUTTER.

Skim, skim, skim, With the skimmer bright; Take the rich and yellow cream, Leave the milk so white.

[Illustration: SKIMMER. [palm upward, fingers slightly curved, moving back and forth]]

Churn, churn, churn, Now 'tis churning day; Till the cream to butter turn Dasher must not stay.

[Illustration: CHURNING. [fists holding imaginary churn-handle]]

Press, press, press; All the milk must be From the golden butter now Pressed out carefully.

[Illustration: LADLE.

(for pressing) [sideways hand]]

[Illustration: BOWL. [curved arm]]

Pat, pat, pat; Make it smooth and round. See! the roll of butter's done-- Won't you buy a pound?

[Illustration: "PAT, PAT, PAT." [hand patting]]

[Illustration: A ROLL OF BUTTER. [fist]]

Taste, oh! taste, This is very nice; Spread it on the children's bread, Give them each a slice.

[Illustration: SPREADING. [index finger of one hand on flat palm of other hand]]

[Music: MAKING BUTTER.

EMILIE POULSSON.

C.C. ROESKE.

1. Skim, skim, skim, With the skimmer bright; Take the rich and yellow cream, Leave the milk so white.]

2. Churn, churn, churn, Now 'tis churning day; Till the cream to butter turn Dasher must not stay.

3. Press, press, press; All the milk must be From the golden butter now Pressed out carefully.

4. Pat, pat, pat, Make it smooth and round. See! the roll of butter's done-- Won't you buy a pound?

5. Taste, oh! taste, This is very nice. Spread it on the children's bread, Give them each a slice.

[Illustration: XVIII. SANTA CLAUS.]

XVIII.--SANTA CLAUS.

O, clap, clap the hands, And sing out with glee For Christmas is coming And merry are we!

[Illustration: CLAPPING

THROUGH THE FIRST AND LAST VERSES.]

Now swift o'er the snow The tiny reindeer Are trotting and bringing Good Santa Claus near.

[Illustration: PAIR OF REINDEER [fingers of both hands downward, thumbs interlaced]

IN SECOND AND FOURTH VERSES.]

Our stockings we'll hang, And while we're asleep Then down through the chimney Will Santa Claus creep.

[Illustration: STOCKINGS. [four fingers hanging downward]]

[Illustration: DOWN THE CHIMNEY. [one fist on top of the other]]

[Illustration: SANTA CLAUS. [fist with thumb extended upward]]

He'll empty his pack, Then up he will come And, calling his reindeer, Will haste away home.

[Illustration: UP HE WILL COME. [one fist on top of the other with thumb extended upward]]

Then clap, clap the hands! And sing out with glee, For Christmas is coming And merry are we!

[Music: SANTA CLAUS.

EMILIE POULSSON.

CORNELIA C. ROESKE.

1. O, clap, clap the hands, And sing out with glee! For Christmas is coming and merry are we! Now swift o'er the snow The tiny reindeer Are trotting and bringing Good Santa Claus near.

2. O, clap, clap the hands, And sing out with glee! For Christmas is coming and merry are we! Our stockings we'll hang, And while we're asleep Then down thro' the

chimney Will Santa Claus creep.

3. O, clap, clap the hands, And sing out with glee! For Christmas is coming and merry are we! He'll empty his pack, Then up he will come And calling the reindeer, Will haste away home.]